



DESIGN EXPLORATION · APRIL 2026

# Zehn — a refined Z-mark

Rebuilding the existing logo on a unified grid: matched stroke weights, flush diagonal, proper safe-area padding. Five directions to choose from.

## What I changed

Four issues with the original, each addressed in the refined version.

### 01 Mismatched stroke weight

Bars are 3.4u tall, the diagonal rect reads thicker because of its angle. Unifying the weight makes the mark feel engineered.

### 03 Cramped padding (blue)

The blue mark has ~15% padding — too tight for iOS safe-area (17–20%). Both colorways are normalized to ~18%.

### 02 Diagonal overlap

The diagonal *covers* the bars. Running it from inner-edge to inner-edge gives clean junctions.

### 04 Container radius

$108/400 \approx 27\%$ . iOS uses a squircle. Matching 22.5% brings it in line with modern icons.

## Before → After

Same mark, rebuilt. Unified stroke, round-capped diagonal nesting between the bars, softer container radius, proper padding.



BEFORE



REFINED — DARK



BEFORE



REFINED — GREEN

## Five directions

Same footprint, different personality. All share the same underlying grid.



**A · Refined**

Direct upgrade. Pill bars, unified stroke, round-capped diagonal flush to inner edges.



**B · Geometric**

Square terminals, minimal corner radius. More engineered.



**C · Monoline**

Single continuous stroke. Friendlier, strongest at small sizes.



**D · Stacked**

"Zehn = ten" list metaphor. Middle tick + faded diagonal.



**E · Open**

Diagonal doesn't touch the bars. Lighter, more typographic.

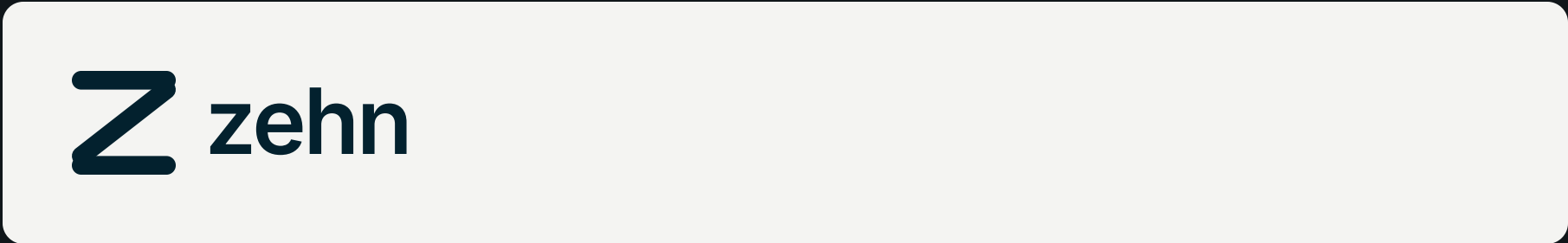
# Scales cleanly

Variant A shown at icon, app-list, favicon, and notification-badge sizes. At 20px the Z still reads.

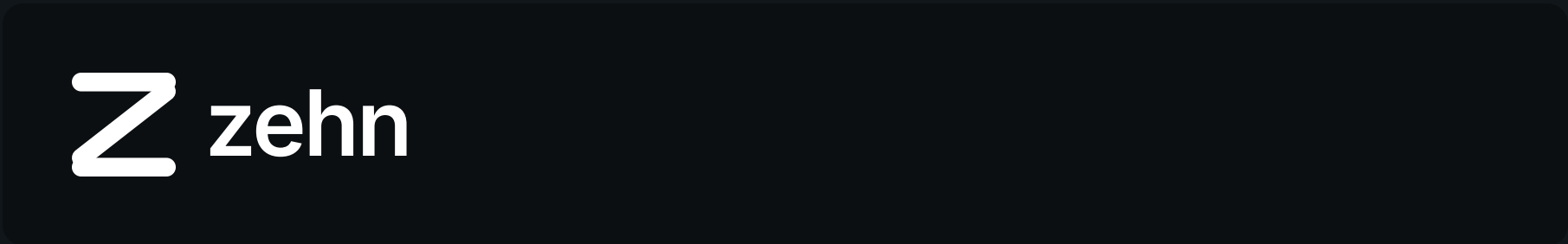


## Lockup with wordmark

Mark + "zehn" lowercase. Inter 600, tight tracking. Works on light, dark, and green.

The image shows the logo lockup 'Z zehn' on a white background. The 'Z' is a dark blue, bold, sans-serif character. The word 'zehn' is in a dark blue, lowercase, sans-serif font with tight letter spacing.

**Z** zehn

The image shows the logo lockup 'Z zehn' on a dark navy blue background. The 'Z' and the word 'zehn' are both white, maintaining the same sans-serif font style and tight tracking as in the previous example.

**Z** zehn

The image shows the logo lockup 'Z zehn' on a bright lime green background. The 'Z' and the word 'zehn' are both dark blue, maintaining the same sans-serif font style and tight tracking as in the previous examples.

**Z** zehn

## Colorways

Original two kept (teal, green) plus options that pair with them.



DEEP TEAL



NEAR BLACK



PAPER



SIGNAL GREEN



WARM LINEN



TEAL + GREEN

## On a home screen

Variant A on an iOS-style grid — sits naturally alongside other app icons.

